



Keep it cool: Isotonic hydration solutions help quickly and effectively replace both the fluids and electrolytes lost during intense exercise. GETTY IMAGES

nutrients.

- Bananas: A great source of potassium, bananas help in maintaining electrolyte balance and preventing muscle cramps.

Using isotonic hydration powders

These are specially formulated mixes which, when combined with water, create a solution that matches the osmolarity of your body fluids. This means they help quickly and effectively replace both the fluids and electrolytes lost during intense exercise.

By drinking isotonic hydration solutions, you can rehydrate faster, maintain your electrolyte balance, and sustain your performance and endurance during your workouts or competitions. Isotonic drinks are specifically designed to replace the electrolytes lost through sweat. Consuming these during intense training sessions can help maintain performance and prevent dehydration.

Adding beetroot to diet

A study found that supplementing with beetroot juice at least six days prior to intense exercise or athletic events can significantly improve stamina and recovery. Beetroot is packed with nitrates, which help in reducing oxygen cost during exercise and improve overall efficiency. This means your muscles need less oxygen to perform the same amount of work. In simpler terms, eating beetroot can make your body more efficient during exercise, allowing you to train harder and recover faster, helping you get the most out of your workouts and competitions. Incorporating beetroot into your diet can make a noticeable difference in performance.

Here are five beetroot-based dishes, smoothies, and salads that can help boost your performance:

- Beetroot smoothie: Blend beetroot with bananas, yoghurt, and a dash of honey for a refreshing and

nutrient-packed smoothie.

- Beetroot salad: Combine roasted beetroot with spinach, feta cheese, walnuts, and some vinegar for a delicious and healthy salad.

- Beetroot hummus: Blend cooked beetroot with chickpeas, tahini, garlic, and lemon juice. Serve with whole grain pita or fresh veggies.

- Beetroot and carrot juice: Mix fresh beetroot and carrot juice with a hint of ginger for a revitalising drink rich in vitamins and antioxidants.

- Beetroot *raita*: Grate beetroot and mix it with curd, cumin powder, and a pinch of salt. This cooling *raita* is perfect as a side dish with meals.

In addition to this, following these tips will prevent serious health issues. Here are some practical tips:

- Carry a water bottle: Keep a water bottle with you and sip regularly throughout the day. Don't wait until you are thirsty to drink water.

- Limit sugary drinks, caffeine, and alcohol: These can act as diuretics, increasing urine production and contributing to dehydration if not balanced with adequate water intake.

- Be cautious of spicy and high-sodium foods: Such foods can increase thirst and fluid loss, disrupting electrolyte balance if not balanced with water intake.

- Hydrate before training: Make it a habit to drink at least one or two glasses of water before starting your training or workout.

- Take regular breaks: Ensure regular breaks in shaded or cool areas during training to prevent overheating and allow the body to recover.

By adopting these simple dietary adjustments and staying vigilant about hydration, you can significantly improve your performance and safety during the hottest months of the year. Eating the right foods and maintaining electrolyte balance is not just about enhancing performance but also about safeguarding health in extreme conditions.

As a sports nutritionist, I cannot stress enough the importance of these practices. Let's stay healthy, hydrated, and high-performing this summer!